

Child Safeguarding Statement

NATURE OF SERVICE & RISK ASSESSMENT

1 NATURE OF SERVICE & COMMITMENT TO SAFEGUARDING

Chosanta Management is fully committed to ensuring that all children who access our service are safe, protected, and supported. The welfare and protection of children is of paramount importance, and we are committed to complying with our obligations under the Children First Act 2015, Children First: National Guidance for the Protection and Welfare of Children (2017), and Tusla's Child Safeguarding: A Guide for Policy, Procedure and Practice.

2 RISK ASSESSMENT

We have carried out a risk assessment to identify potential risks of harm to children availing of our services and have put in place policies and procedures to manage these risks. Identified risks may include:

- ✓ Children being exposed to inappropriate or harmful behaviour by adults in shared accommodation settings
- ✓ Inadequate supervision or oversight in communal areas
- ✓ Staff or volunteers failing to identify or respond appropriately to child welfare concerns
- ✓ Inappropriate online or phone contact between staff/volunteers and children
- ✓ Risks associated with outings, transport, or one-to-one work

A full written risk assessment is available upon request.

3 PROCEDURES TO MANAGE RISKS

We have developed and implemented the following procedures to support our Child Safeguarding Statement:

- ✓ Procedure for recognising, responding to, and reporting child protection and welfare concerns to Tusla
- ✓ Procedure for dealing with allegations or suspicions of abuse or misconduct by a staff member or volunteer
- ✓ Procedure for safe recruitment and vetting of all staff and volunteers who work with children or families
- ✓ Procedure for child protection induction and ongoing training for staff and volunteers
- ✓ Procedure for maintaining a list of mandated persons under the Children First Act 2015
- ✓ Procedure for managing visitor access and communal space supervision
- ✓ Code of behaviour for staff and volunteers when interacting with children

Child Safeguarding Statement

IMPLEMENTATION, REVIEW & RELEVANT PERSON

4 IMPLEMENTATION & REVIEW

We are committed to the effective implementation of this Child Safeguarding Statement and all related procedures to ensure the safety of children using our service.

This statement will be reviewed every 12 months, or sooner if there is a material change in any matter to which it refers.

5 RELEVANT PERSON (CHILDREN FIRST ACT 2015)

Name: _____

Role: _____

Contact Information: _____

Date this statement was adopted: _____

Next review date: _____

Child Protection & Safeguarding Policy

SECTIONS 1–5: STATEMENT, SCOPE, DEFINITIONS & DLP

1 POLICY STATEMENT

Chosanta Management is committed to safeguarding and promoting the welfare of all children and families who use our services. We recognise that children living in homeless accommodation may face particular vulnerabilities, and we take our responsibility to protect them from harm seriously.

This policy is in line with:

- ✓ Children First Act 2015
- ✓ Children First: National Guidance for the Protection and Welfare of Children (2017)
- ✓ Tusla Child Safeguarding: A Guide for Policy, Procedure and Practice
- ✓ National Vetting Bureau (Children and Vulnerable Persons) Acts 2012–2016

2 SCOPE

- ✓ All staff (full-time, part-time, relief)
- ✓ Volunteers and interns
- ✓ Students on placement
- ✓ Contractors and service providers who engage with children on site

3 DEFINITIONS

- ✓ **Child:** A person under the age of 18 years who is not or has not been married
- ✓ **Harm:** As defined in the Children First Act 2015 — assault, ill-treatment, neglect, or sexual abuse
- ✓ **Mandated Person:** A person defined in Schedule 2 of the Children First Act 2015, who has a legal obligation to report harm to Tusla

4 DESIGNATED LIAISON PERSON (DLP)

Our appointed Designated Liaison Person (DLP) is responsible for ensuring that child protection concerns are appropriately reported to Tusla.

DLP Name: _____
 Phone: _____
 Email: _____
 Deputy DLP: _____

5 RECOGNISING & RESPONDING TO ABUSE

Staff must be alert to signs of:

- ✓ Neglect
- ✓ Physical abuse
- ✓ Emotional abuse
- ✓ Sexual abuse

Child Protection & Safeguarding Policy

SECTIONS 5-9: RESPONSE, REPORTING, RECRUITMENT & CONDUCT

If a staff member has a concern:

- ✓ Record the concern using the Incident/Concern Form
- ✓ Consult with the DLP
- ✓ The DLP will decide whether to report to Tusla using the Child Protection and Welfare Report Form (CPWRF)
- ✓ In emergency situations, contact An Garda Síochána

6 MANDATED REPORTING

Staff who are mandated persons must:

- ✓ Report harm to Tusla when it meets the legal threshold
- ✓ Cooperate with Tusla or An Garda Síochána investigations

7 SAFE RECRUITMENT

We are committed to safe recruitment by:

- ✓ Garda Vetting all staff and volunteers working with children
- ✓ Conducting face-to-face interviews
- ✓ Obtaining references
- ✓ Including child safeguarding as part of induction

8 CODE OF BEHAVIOUR FOR STAFF & VOLUNTEERS

All staff must:

- ✓ Treat all children with dignity and respect
- ✓ Avoid being alone with a child where possible
- ✓ Use appropriate language and tone
- ✓ Never use physical punishment
- ✓ Avoid any behaviour that could be perceived as exploitative or abusive

9 SUPERVISION OF CHILDREN IN ACCOMMODATION

- ✓ Monitor common areas
- ✓ Limit and supervise visitor access
- ✓ Encourage family units to stay together
- ✓ Immediately respond to concerns raised by staff, residents, or others
- ✓ Use a visitor log and incident reporting system

Child Protection & Safeguarding Policy

SECTIONS 10–15: ALLEGATIONS, CONFIDENTIALITY, TRAINING & REVIEW

10 ALLEGATIONS AGAINST STAFF OR VOLUNTEERS

All allegations or suspicions will be:

- ✓ Taken seriously
- ✓ Reported to the DLP and Tusla (and Gardaí where appropriate)
- ✓ Investigated internally in line with fair procedures and employment law
- ✓ Support will be provided to both the child and the staff member under investigation

11 CONFIDENTIALITY

- ✓ Confidentiality will be maintained except where there is a child protection concern
- ✓ Information will be shared on a "need to know" basis
- ✓ All records will be securely stored in line with GDPR

12 TRAINING

- ✓ All staff must complete Tusla's Children First eLearning Programme
- ✓ Safeguarding induction is provided to all new staff
- ✓ Regular refresher training is scheduled every 2 years
- ✓ DLPs must attend advanced child protection training

13 RECORD KEEPING

- ✓ Concerns and referrals are recorded using the standard form
- ✓ Records are stored securely and confidentially
- ✓ Only the DLP and relevant managers have access

14 COMPLAINTS & WHISTLEBLOWING

- ✓ We have a clear complaints process accessible to residents
- ✓ Staff are encouraged to raise concerns through the Whistleblowing Policy, without fear of reprisal

15 REVIEW OF POLICY

This policy is reviewed every 12 months or earlier if there are changes in legislation or guidance, or a critical incident occurs.

Policy Sign-Off & Approval

AUTHORISATION & REVIEW SCHEDULE



APPROVAL DETAILS

Policy last reviewed on: _____

Next scheduled review: _____



AUTHORISED SIGNATORY

Signed: _____

Name: _____

Role: _____

Date: _____